LumiaKey Functional Guide

LumiaKey turns a phone or tablet into a computer shortcut panel with keyboard actions, media controls, touch input and local speech recognition. This guide helps new users understand the mobile app, LumiaKey Desktop and the requirements for each feature.

This guide covers version 1.3.0+5 with the computer modes update of 10 November 2026 (d01db29). The interface is primarily English. Recognition language is configured separately.

Screenshots show the current Flutter interface in tests. Connections, installed apps, key bindings, usage counts and dictation states use sample data.

Mode	Supported devices	Connection and bindings
Bluetooth only	Android 9 or later with Bluetooth HID Device support	Pair over Bluetooth and set up app shortcuts for each computer
Desktop advanced	Android, iPhone and iPad	Run LumiaKey Desktop on Windows or macOS. Advanced mode starts automatically when it connects over the local network.

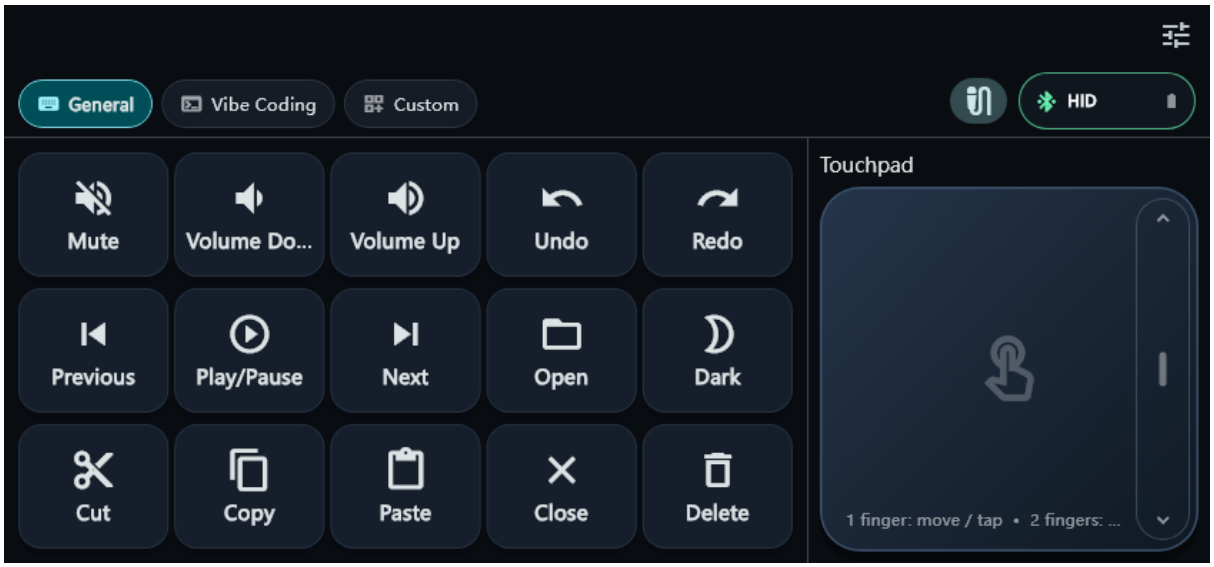


Figure 1 Default General profile in landscape with the touchpad on the right

1 Connect to a Computer

Android can connect over Bluetooth or through LumiaKey Desktop on the same local network. When both are connected, the app uses Desktop advanced mode for application shortcuts. See the iOS section for iPhone and iPad pairing.

1. For Bluetooth only, open the connection panel from the Android status menu or Settings → Computer connection. Grant Nearby devices access and choose Make discoverable.

2. Pair the phone in the computer's Bluetooth settings. Return to LumiaKey, refresh the list and tap Connect next to the computer. The first connection opens its app setup wizard.

3. For advanced mode, start LumiaKey Desktop and choose Open Settings in the Windows tray or macOS menu bar. Put both devices on the same local network and check Settings → Desktop Companion on the phone.

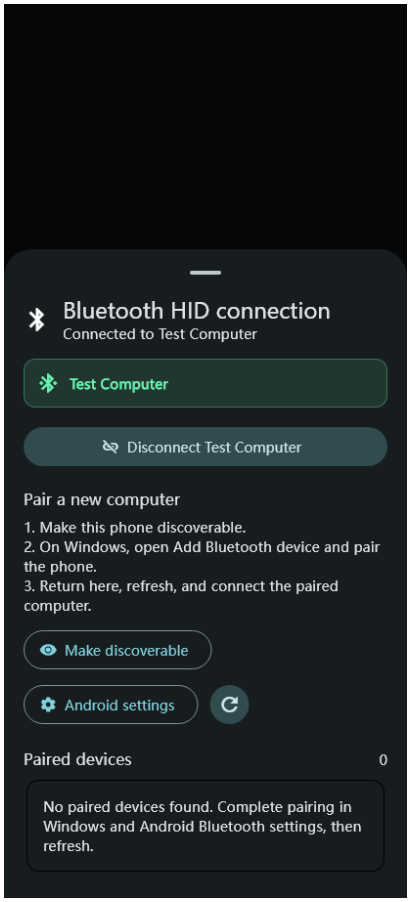


Figure 2 Bluetooth connection panel with a sample computer

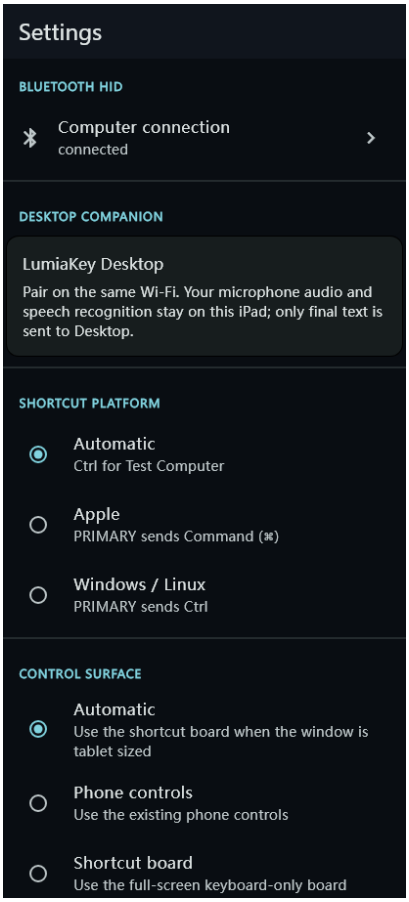


Figure 3 Settings and the Desktop Companion section

2 First Connection Setup

On the first connection to a computer, choose the apps to show in the top row. App choices and bindings are saved for that computer. Use the settings icon at the right of the app row to change them later.

1. Select the apps you use, such as Chrome, Teams, Zoom, Codex, Claude or Cursor. For general controls only, leave the list empty and choose Use General only.

2. In Desktop advanced mode, choose from the detected apps and tap Use Desktop apps. Desktop provides the bindings.

3. In Bluetooth mode on Android, expand each selected app and enter its Launch app shortcut and required action keys. Meeting apps ask for microphone, camera and raise-hand shortcuts. See section 9 for the Vibe Coding actions.

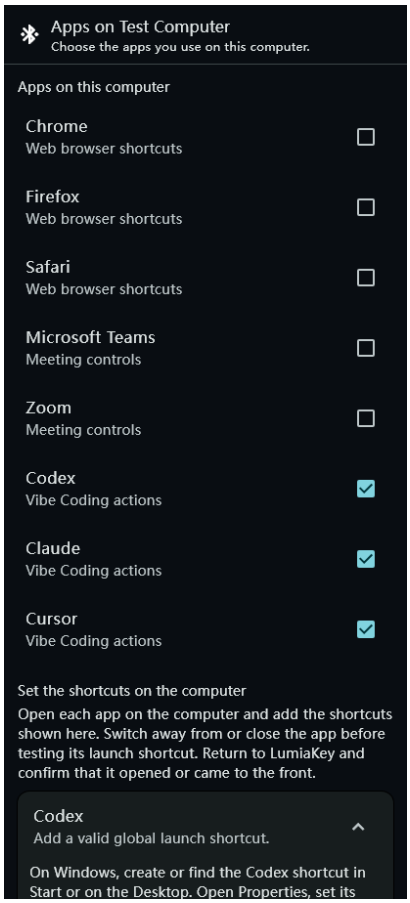


Figure 4 Choose apps for this computer

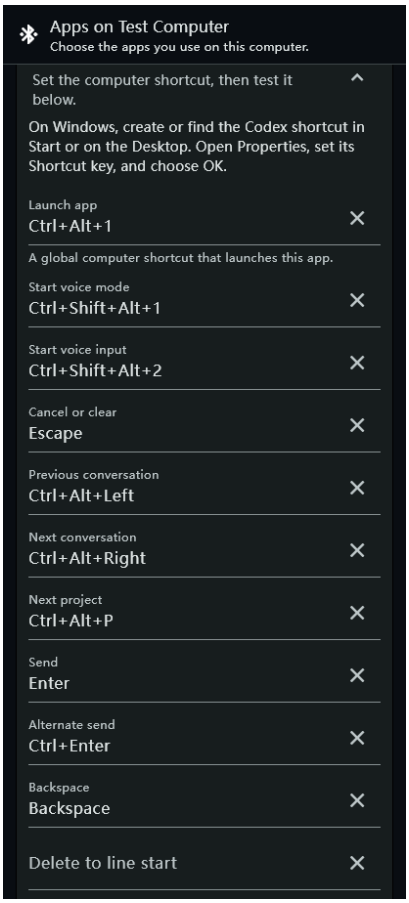


Figure 5 Enter app shortcuts

3 Test Bluetooth App Launch

Bluetooth mode launches an app through a global shortcut configured on the computer. Set it there first, then enter the same key combination under Launch app in LumiaKey.

1. On Windows, open Properties for the app shortcut in Start or on the desktop and set its Shortcut key. On macOS, create an Open App action in Shortcuts and choose Add Keyboard Shortcut.

2. Switch away from the target app or close it, then tap Test app launch shortcut on the phone. When the app opens or comes forward, select I saw this app open. Test again whenever you change its launch key.

3. Test every selected app and fill in its required shortcuts. Tap Save settings to add the apps to the home row.

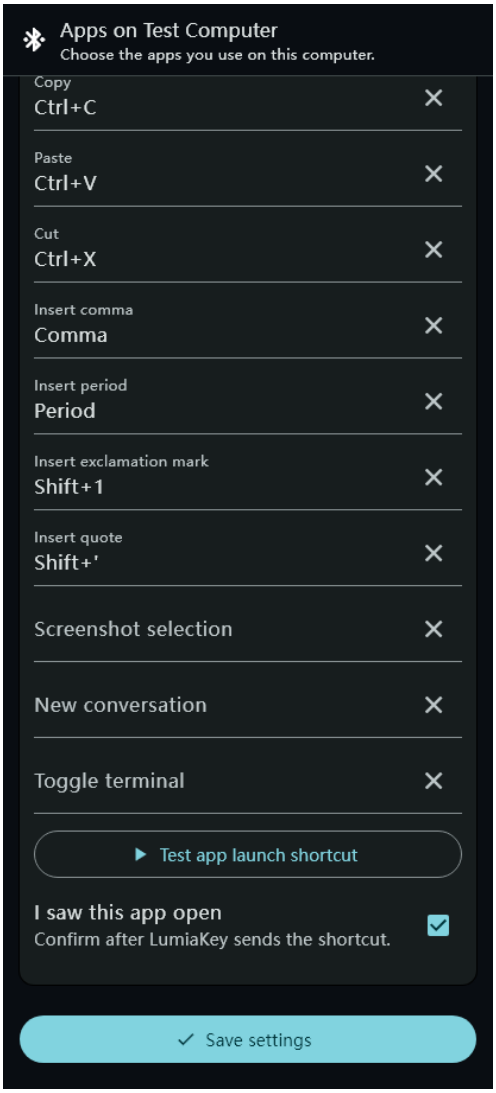


Figure 6 Confirm the app opened on the computer

4 Pair an iPhone or iPad

An iPhone or iPad must pair with LumiaKey Desktop before it can show the shortcut controls. Put both devices on the same local network.

1. Run LumiaKey Desktop on Windows or macOS. In Connect an iPhone or iPad, select an address reachable by the device and choose Copy iPhone / iPad connection code.

2. Open LumiaKey on the iPhone or iPad. Paste the code into Desktop connection code and tap Connect. Allow Local Network access if prompted.

3. After the first successful pairing, choose the computer's apps in the wizard and save. If Desktop restarts or the connection expires, copy a fresh code and pair again.

The code contains a temporary credential. Keep it private. Local communication authenticates requests over unencrypted HTTP, so pair on a trusted network.

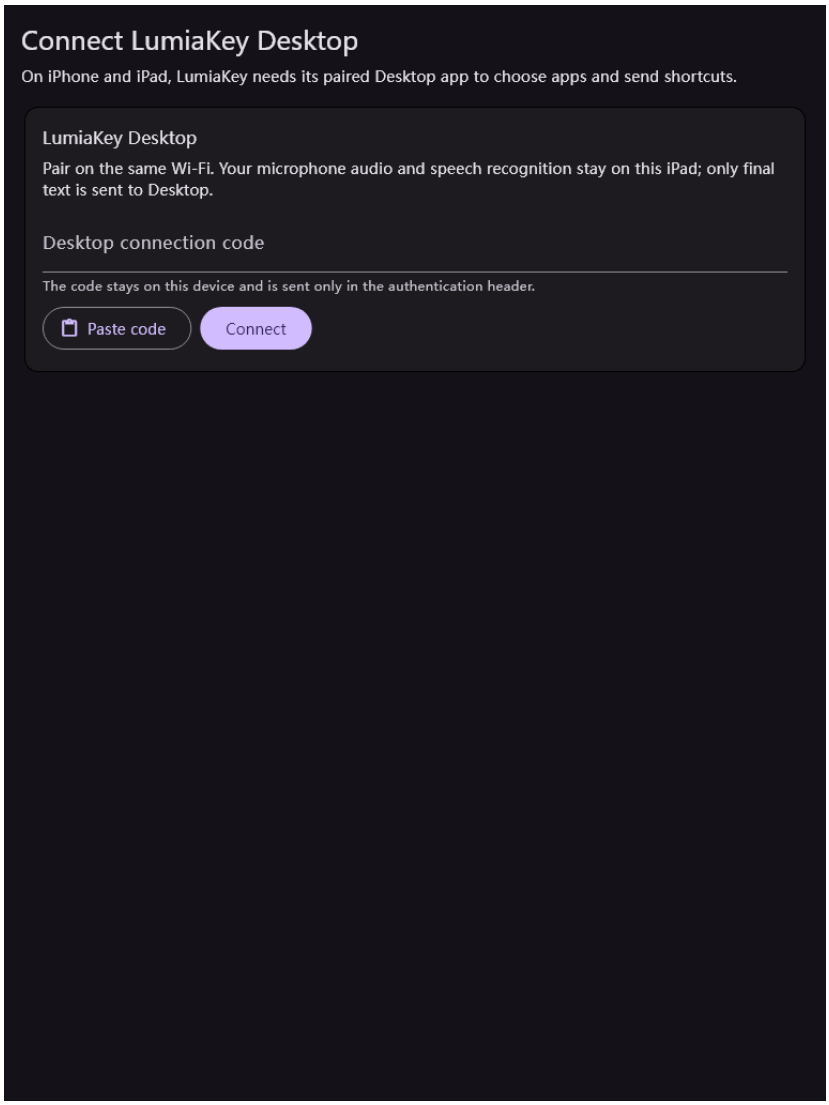


Figure 7 First-launch iPad pairing screen with an empty code field

5 Control Surfaces and Touch Input

Phone controls show up to 15 shortcuts per bank: three columns by five rows in portrait and five columns by three rows in landscape. Rotation releases held keys while preserving the active configuration.

General includes mute, volume, undo, redo, previous track, play/pause, next track, open, Dark, cut, copy, paste, close and delete. Keep the intended app focused; shortcut behavior depends on that app. Dark dims the phone and requests host brightness control when Desktop is available; host effects depend on platform support.

On the Android Bluetooth touchpad, drag one finger to move the pointer, tap for left-click, slide two fingers to scroll and tap two fingers for right-click. The right-edge strip supports one-finger scrolling. Other profiles can use an editable navigation wheel. iOS sends supported keyboard shortcuts through Desktop.

Settings → Control Surface offers Automatic, Phone controls and Shortcut board. Automatic uses the board when the window's shortest side reaches 600 logical pixels; narrow split views return to phone controls.

Shortcut board keys per screen accepts any integer from 24 to 60, with 40 as the default. The board omits the touchpad and wheel. Use page controls for other banks. Existing 15-key profiles stay intact; editing an unused slot adds a key.

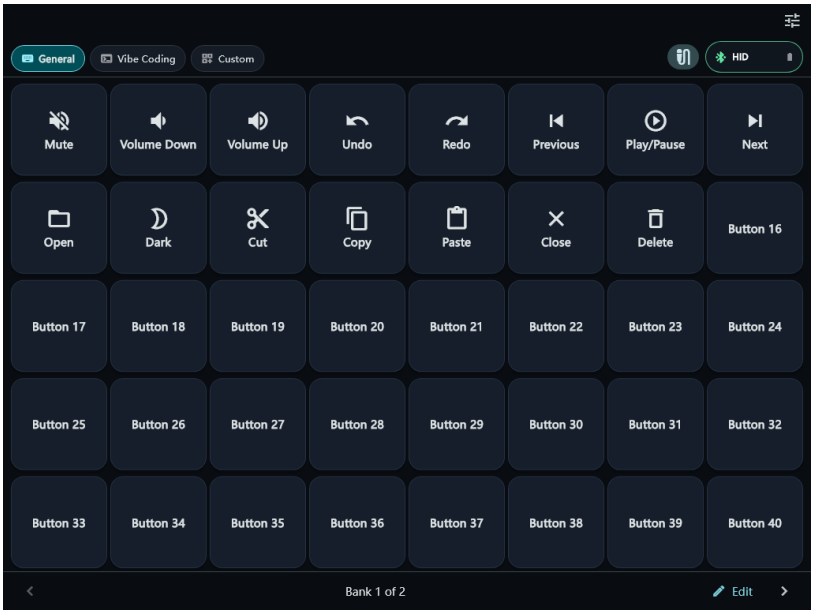


Figure 8 Tablet board with 40 slots; unused positions remain unconfigured

6 Profiles and Button Editing

A Profile stores buttons, visuals and navigation actions. The initial local profiles are General, Web, Zoom / Teams and Custom. The free edition supports up to four local profiles.

1. Switch visible profiles below the app row. Once connected, open browsers and meeting apps from the top row. Settings → Profiles lets you create, copy, edit, reorder, delete, set a default or restore a template. Importing at capacity requires choosing a replacement slot.

2. Choose Edit buttons from the top-right menu, then tap a button. Set its label, icon or image, action and feedback, save, then leave edit mode. Long-press and drag onto another button to swap their complete configurations.

3. PRIMARY maps to Command on Apple hosts and Ctrl on Windows or Linux. If automatic detection is incorrect, set the host platform manually in Settings → Shortcut Platform.

Edit Desktop-managed app layouts in Desktop → Shortcut Layout. Phone Profile JSON import rejects Companion actions. Desktop layouts and phone Bluetooth profiles are different transfer formats.



Figure 9 Profile management with a sample list

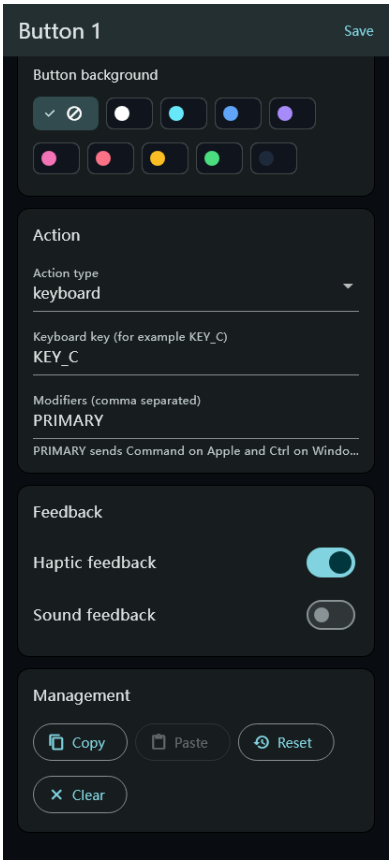


Figure 10 Button action editor

7 Icons and Profile Exchange

Buttons can display text, built-in semantic icons or custom PNG, JPEG and WebP images. Shortcut Community provides curated offline packs and Profile exchange through the clipboard or files.

1. Open the icon picker from the button editor. Search by keyword or filter by category; use recent choices, favorites, preview, size and color controls. Custom images are copied into app-private storage and support fit, scale, position and label overlays.

2. Open Settings → Shortcut Community, choose a built-in pack or paste/import Profile JSON. Review it and confirm the replacement slot before changing the current configuration.

3. Use Copy active Profile JSON or export a .smartkeys.json file. Copying JSON does not transfer private image files to another device; use an account backup that includes images when needed.

Missing images display a placeholder and must be reimported or restored. Offline packs and online usage rankings are separate features; offline packs do not require a community server.

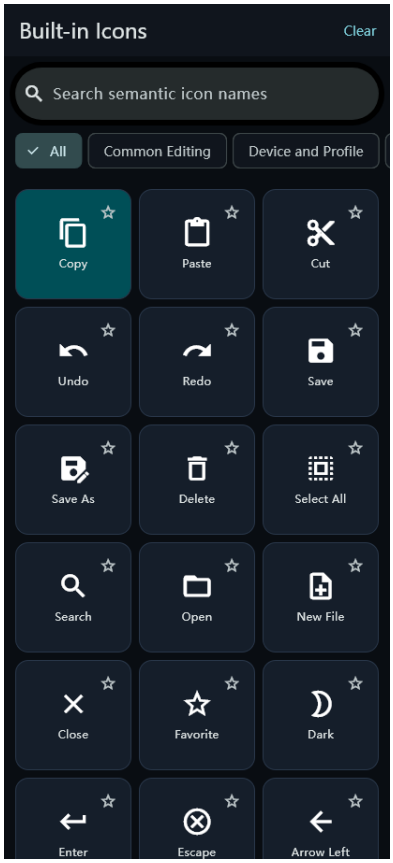


Figure 11 Built-in icon picker

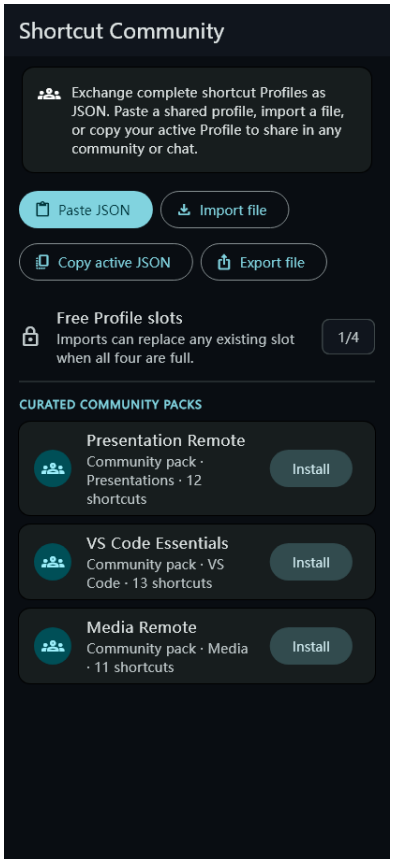


Figure 12 Offline packs and JSON exchange

8 App Row and Shortcuts

The top row shows the apps selected for the current computer. Tap an app to launch or focus it on the computer and open its shortcut controls on mobile.

Bluetooth mode uses the launch and action shortcuts saved in the wizard. Keep the intended app in front when sending a shortcut.

In advanced mode, turn on Enable Apps Sync and Auto Launch Apps under Desktop → General. The row shows selected apps that Desktop detects and uses their managed layouts.

Browser layouts offer tab switching, navigation and refresh. Teams and Zoom layouts include meeting controls for the microphone, camera and raising a hand. App and shortcut availability depends on the computer platform and installed version.

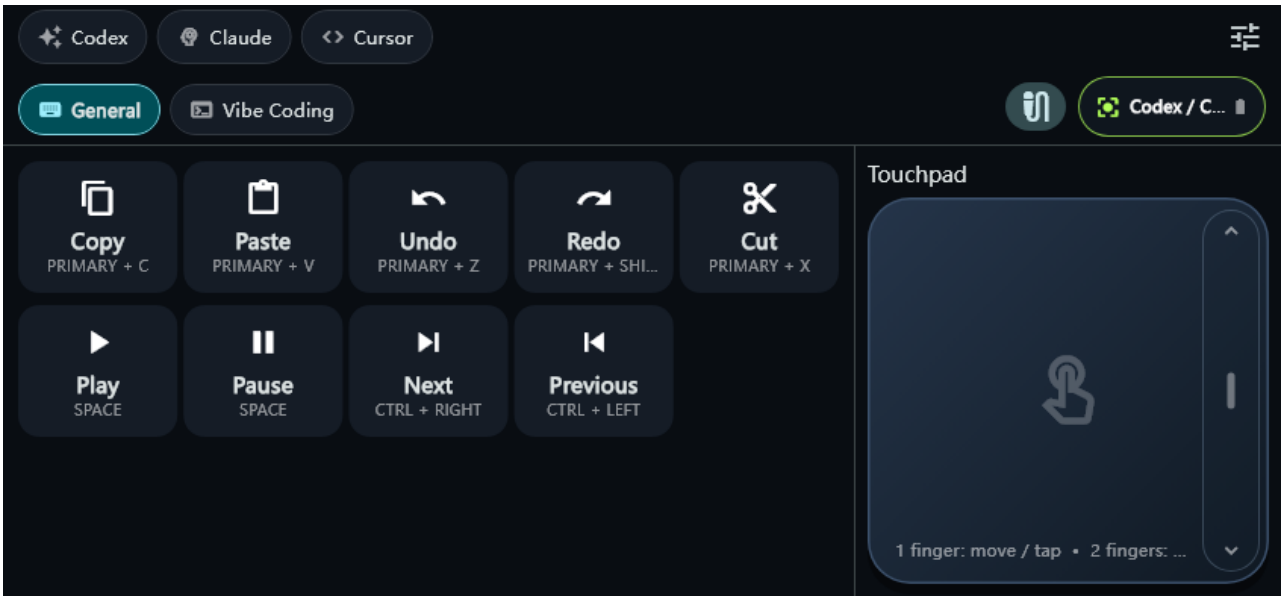


Figure 13 Selected apps above General in advanced mode

9 Vibe Coding

Select Codex, Claude or Cursor in setup, then use the top app row to launch or switch apps. The single Vibe Coding tab shows the keys for the selected app.

In Bluetooth mode, configure Start voice mode, Start voice input, Cancel or clear, Previous conversation, Next conversation and Next project. Use different chords for the two voice actions. The buttons send the configured computer shortcuts.

In advanced mode, bring the target app to the front, then use Start or Stop under Local Dictation. The mobile device recognizes speech locally and Desktop delivers the final text. Follow the setup prompt for the local model on first use.

Advanced layouts also include project, chat, send, backspace, clipboard, punctuation and region screenshot controls. Codex opens its project picker. Claude lets you choose a folder in a new Code session. Cursor opens the command palette for folders or recent projects.

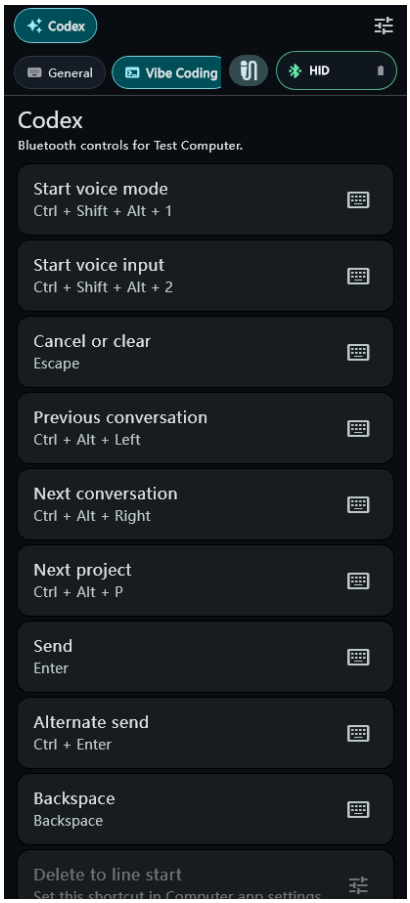


Figure 14 Vibe Coding over Bluetooth

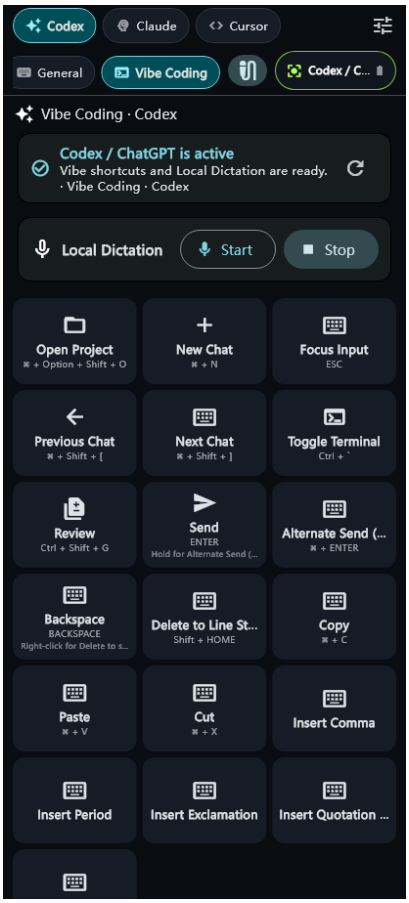


Figure 15 Advanced mode with Local Dictation

10 Desktop Settings

LumiaKey Desktop starts in the system tray or menu bar. Choose Open Settings to show its window. Closing settings hides the app; choose Quit to exit.

General manages Enable Apps Sync, Auto Launch Apps, Sync Icons and the current phone/profile. Bluetooth shows connection guidance. Apps detects supported installed programs and refreshes running state. Profiles manages Desktop profiles; About shows product information.

The screenshot shows a disconnected example. If Sync service unavailable appears during use, check the Desktop service, firewall and LAN connection. No phone connected means there is no active phone session.

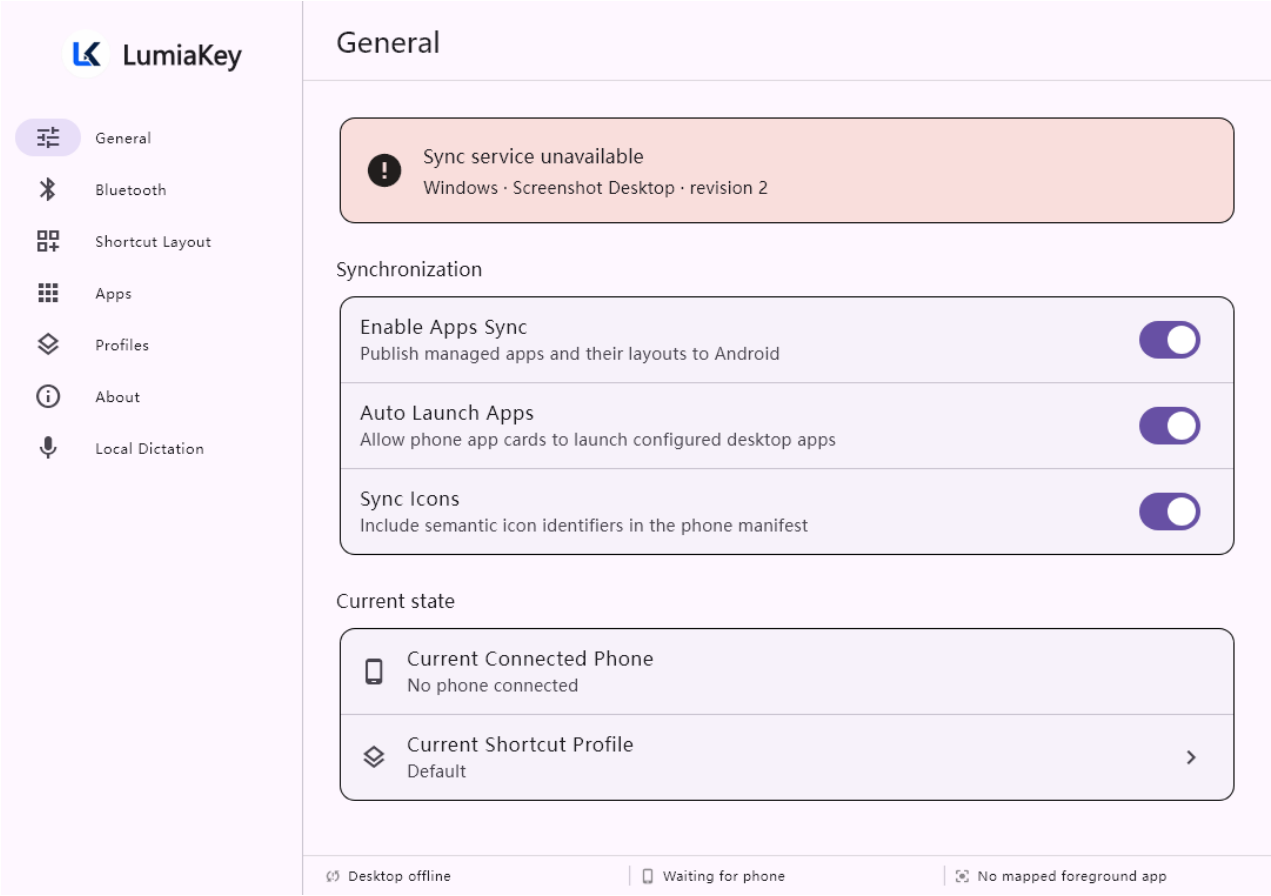


Figure 16 Desktop General settings with synchronization inactive in the test

11 Desktop Shortcut Management

Desktop owns app layouts and synchronizes them to mobile. Select the correct app and layout before editing, then verify the saved result in the target app.

In Shortcut Layout, select an app and button, then edit Button Name, Icon, Target Type, Shortcut, Launch App, URL and Description. Keyboard Shortcut, Launch Application and Open URL are executable; Macro and Script are currently unavailable.

Desktop layout JSON can be imported and exported; exports omit executable data. Imports replace known layouts and validate app IDs. Desktop owns executable paths and resolves the button IDs sent by mobile into actions.

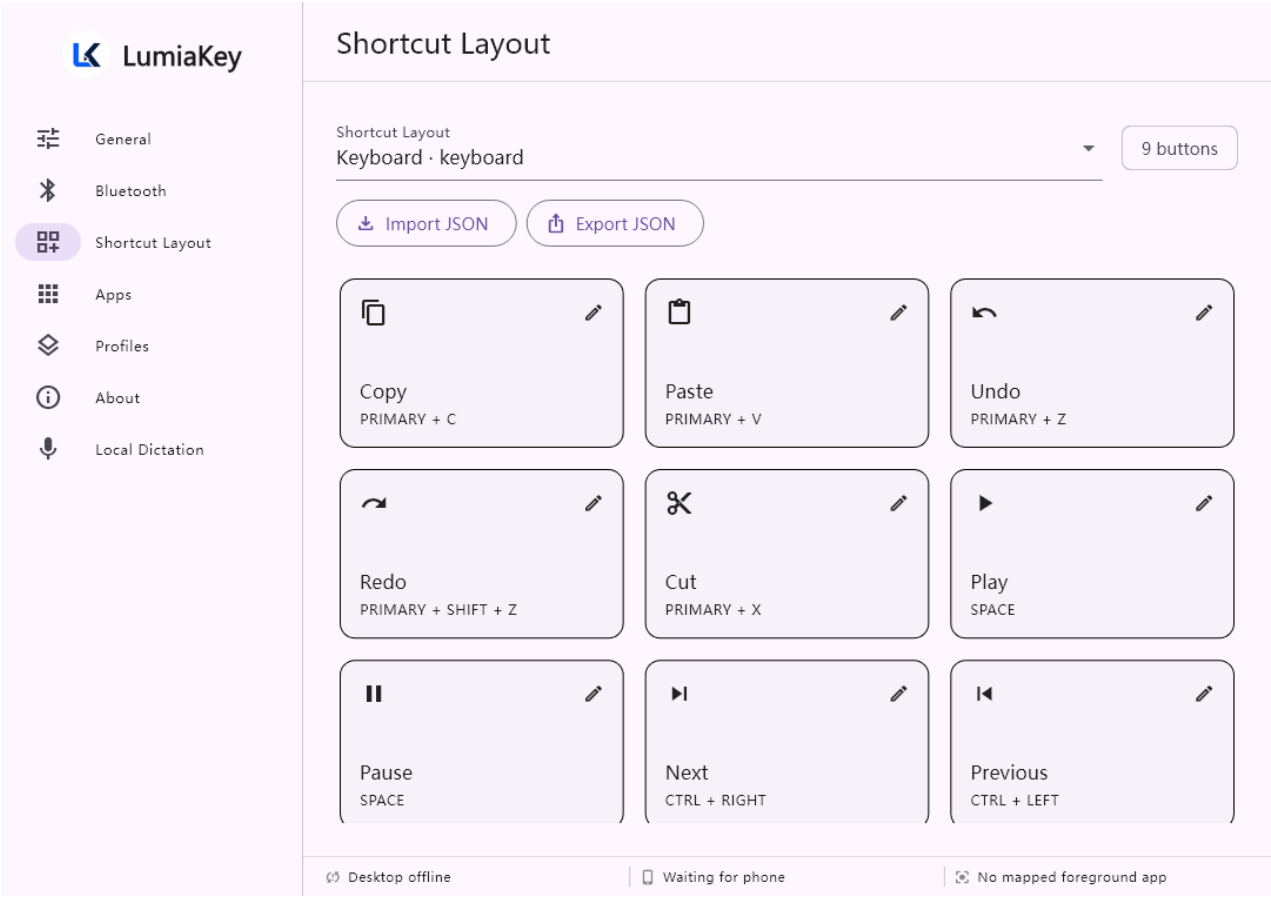


Figure 17 Desktop shortcut layout management

12 Mobile Local Quick Dictation

Local quick dictation uses the phone's microphone and a local recognition model. It differs from the Application voice input waveform button, which triggers the target app's own voice shortcut. First use requires acknowledging the explanation.

1. Long-press the microphone to choose output, model and recognition language, then explicitly download or import a model. SenseVoice Small is the default at about 229 MiB; Cohere Transcribe is an optional model at about 2.7 GiB. Files must pass size and SHA-256 checks.

2. Bluetooth output is English-only and requires English input with a US keyboard layout on the computer. For Chinese or other multilingual text, choose LumiaKey Desktop and connect it on the same LAN. There is no automatic Bluetooth fallback.

3. When the model and output are ready, tap the microphone to start. Shortcuts remain usable while listening; the corner control shows the level and Stop. Stop ends capture. Back, settings, leaving the foreground or connection changes cancel capture.

Audio stays in bounded memory and is neither saved as a recording/history nor sent to Desktop. Desktop mode sends finalized text only. Ready/listening screenshots use test states rather than evidence of a model download or recognition quality.

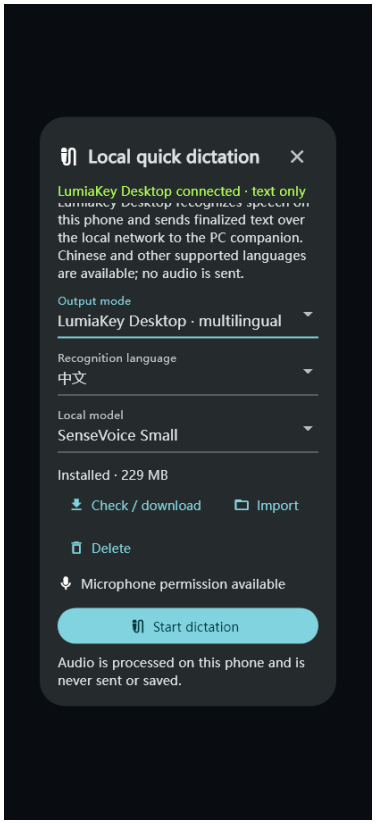


Figure 18 Multilingual Desktop output setup example



Figure 19 Compact stop and level control while listening

13 Desktop Local Dictation

Desktop can independently dictate with the computer's microphone and a local model, without capturing audio on the phone. Final text is inserted into a supported focused external app.

1. Open settings from the tray and select Local Dictation. Choose a model and recognition language, then download or import the model. Downloads are explicit. Allow microphone access in Windows privacy settings or the macOS prompt.

2. Focus an editable field in the target app. The default global shortcut Ctrl+Shift+Space starts or stops dictation; the tray offers Start/Stop Local Dictation too. Change the shortcut in settings if needed.

3. On macOS, text insertion also needs Accessibility and event-posting permission. Insertion can be rejected if focus is unsafe, the target changes or Desktop's own window is targeted. Refocus the intended app and retry explicitly.

Microphone audio is processed in local memory without saving recordings. Model readiness does not verify microphone permission, recognition accuracy or insertion into a particular app. Check the first output in disposable text.

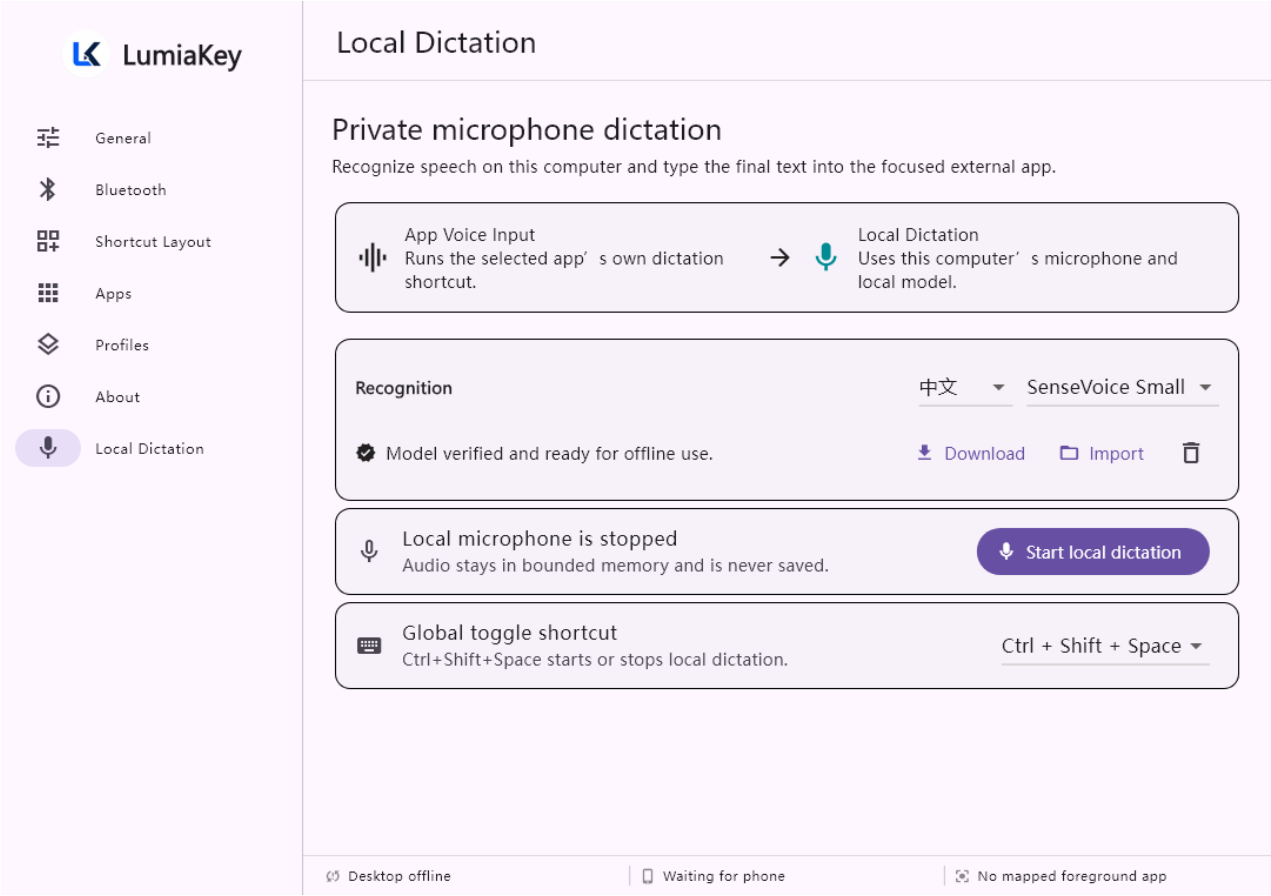


Figure 20 Desktop local dictation with sample model and language state

14 Usage and Optional Community Sharing

Settings → Usage Dashboard records nonempty shortcut click attempts and times. Failed or disconnected attempts also count, so clicks are not successful executions. Detailed history stays on the device by default.

Choose All time, Today, 7 days, 30 days or custom dates. Sort by usage or latest use and inspect individual events. Smart sort explicitly reorders the current local Profile by lifetime counts; it does not reorder Desktop-managed layouts. Clear local usage requires confirmation.

First-launch Community setup offers optional profession and computer-proficiency tags, or Skip for now. Saving stores local defaults without enabling sharing. Reopen it through Settings → Community sharing setup. Every submission still requires preview and confirmation.

Optional submissions contain recognized standard categories and aggregate counts, excluding custom labels, exact times and raw commands. Rankings need a configured service but do not require sharing. Categories require three contribution batches; batches are not people. Online withdrawal and local clearing are separate. The optional service also offers a Chinese browser Dashboard with counts, a proportional chart, a table and period/profession/proficiency filters.

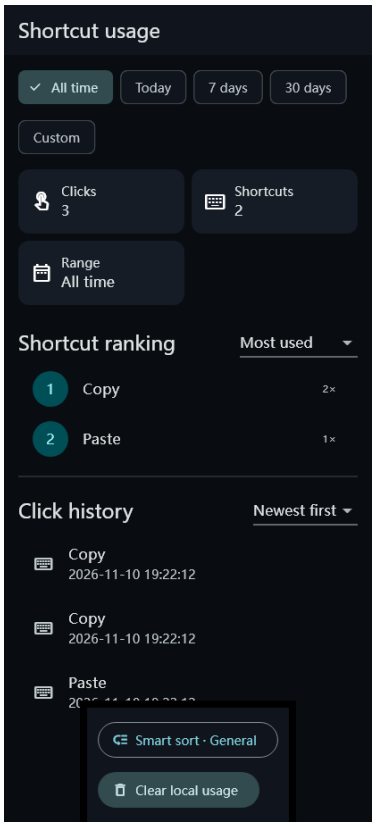


Figure 21 Usage dashboard with sample counts and times

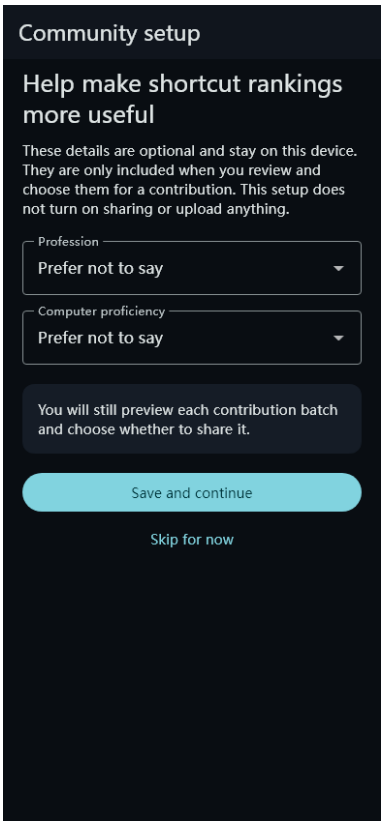


Figure 22 Optional community setup

15 Backup Restore and Desktop Installers

Account backup is separate from community sharing. The settings entry currently says Google Drive backup, but Google sign-in accesses a separate backup service rather than storing files in your Google Drive.

Once the service and Google OAuth are configured, sign in, select app settings, Profiles and optional custom images, preview and back up manually. Each account stores its latest snapshot. Restore selected items within the four-profile limit; restoration does not execute shortcuts.

Pairing, click history, sharing receipts and login credentials are excluded. Signing out does not delete the online snapshot; use Delete online backup separately. An unconfigured build shows an unavailable message rather than simulated sign-in or fabricated backups.

On Android, Settings → Desktop installers shows the Windows installer and macOS DMG bundled in a release. Review version, source commit, size and SHA-256, and verify them. Development builds may contain no installers.

Choose a shared-storage destination in the system folder picker. Export does not overwrite an existing file and verifies stored size and hash. Use USB file transfer/MTP to copy the package to the computer, then install it; the phone does not become a USB mass-storage drive.

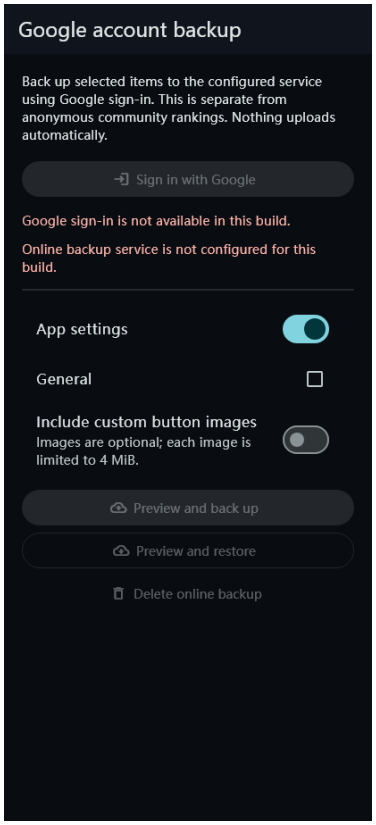


Figure 23 Backup configuration message



Figure 24 Installer catalog with test package metadata

16 Display Settings and Troubleshooting

Settings offers Landscape, Portrait and Auto, with landscape as the default, plus charging-brightness and wake options. Dictation keeps the screen awake while active and releases its wake state when stopped or cancelled.

If a computer is missing from the Bluetooth list, pair it in system settings and refresh. For Desktop connection issues, check that both devices are on the same network, Desktop is running and the firewall allows access. Copy a fresh code if iPhone or iPad pairing expires.

If an app does not open, retest its global launch shortcut in Bluetooth mode, or check Enable Apps Sync and Auto Launch Apps in advanced mode. For an unexpected key action, check foreground focus, Shortcut Platform and the saved chord. Multilingual dictation needs a live LumiaKey Desktop connection.

Model or microphone unavailable: complete model verification and check system microphone permission. Deleting a model stops capture first. Unconfigured rankings or backup need release-service configuration; local statistics and offline profiles remain usable.

This guide checks source behavior and rendered test screens. Physical Android Bluetooth input, speech accuracy and latency, Windows/macOS permissions and text delivery, and iPhone/iPad installation and pairing need device testing.

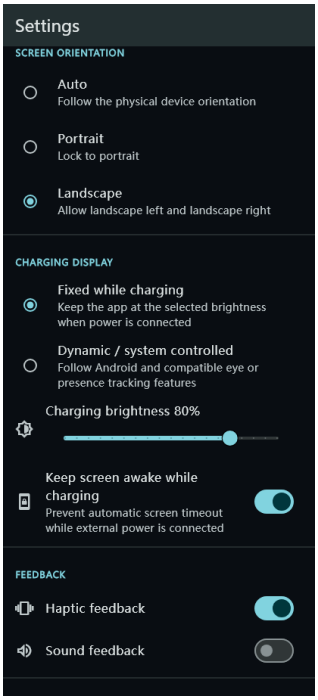


Figure 25 Screen orientation and charging display settings